



ArchBang Linux

ArchBang Linux is a simple GNU/Linux Operating System that combines the lightweight Arch Linux with the fast and simple Openbox window manager. It reduces the entry barrier to using Arch, especially for new users, who might find the default Arch set-up process cumbersome or intimidating. This article, written by a primary contributor to the project, explains differences between Arch Linux and ArchBang, and why new users might prefer to use ArchBang over Arch Linux. It also covers some of the history of how the new distro came about, and future directions.

ArchBang Linux (<http://www.archbang.org>) aims to provide an out-of-the-box Arch Linux experience with a pre-configured Openbox desktop suite, whilst being simple and adhering to *The Arch Way*, which is a set of principles that govern the development, maintenance and distribution process of Arch Linux (Simplicity, Code-correctness, User-centric, Openness and Freedom). ArchBang is available in both 32-bit and 64-bit versions.

The name ArchBang is inspired by #!CrunchBang Linux, an Openbox-based spin-off of Ubuntu (though they are now changing from Ubuntu to Debian sources).

Differences between Arch Linux and ArchBang

The key difference between the two is that Arch Linux gives you a very basic core system, while ArchBang gives you an out-of-the-box working

desktop system. You can use the latter as a Live CD, as well as install it on a pen drive.

Arch Linux is aimed at the intermediate (or expert, but not newbie) Linux users who have a working knowledge of their hardware. "Arch is what you make of it" is a common phrase used in the Arch community, which emphasises that Arch Linux can be a simple, lightweight system with a window manager like Openbox or Xmonad, or could be a full-blown heavy desktop system with a desktop manager like KDE or GNOME, and myriad tools and applications installed. Arch Linux, by default, does not provide a desktop, X windowing system, or even many hardware drivers.

However, with ArchBang, you can pre-install and configure a common set of video drivers on top of the base Arch Linux system (and also supply the proprietary Nvidia driver as an optional package for users to choose to install). You can also add audio features